

Vanadium

In ancient India, metalworkers learned to make iron swords harder and sharper by adding tiny amounts of vanadinite, the main ore of vanadium. Today, 85 per cent of the pure vanadium produced is used to make super-tough types of steel.

ATOMIC MASS 50.942

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1801 (Andrés Manuel del Río)



**Red crystals of vanadinite,
an ore of vanadium**

